FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17028

Issue Title : Low Parking Brake Accumulator Pressures

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3244-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737, 737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
10/10/2017	10/10/2017	09/27/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

All 737MAX -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Description

This FTD article provides troubleshooting suggestions for reports of low brake pressures, as read by the BRAKE PRESS gage in the flight deck. Please note that this article is not intended to address rapid parking brake pressure bleed down rates.

Background

A review of unscheduled maintenance events for several customers' fleets revealed that some airplanes are experiencing repeated write-ups for low brake accumulator pressures. The reports are usually one of the following:

1) Flight crews report lower than normal pressures on the BRAKE PRESS gage in the flight deck during cruise. Normally, the gage should read about 3000 psi in flight but flight crews occasionally report seeing the gage read less, such as 2500 or 2600 psi.

2) Crews report seeing brake pressures as low as 300 psi or 500 psi on the BRAKE PRESS gage when the accumulator is depleted. The correct pressure when the accumulator is depleted (the precharge pressure) should be about 1000 psi.

3) Flight crews report that the pressure as read by the BRAKE PRESS gage does not come up to the expected 3000 psi when the "B" hydraulic pumps are turned on.

The maintenance records often showed that the corrective action was to either service the brake accumulator with nitrogen or to replace the entire brake accumulator. In most cases, these maintenance actions did not permanently resolve the issue since the same problem re-occurred numerous times in subsequent weeks or months.

It is our experience that when any of these symptoms are experienced, the problem is most likely a nitrogen leak on the gas-side of the brake accumulator circuit. Re-servicing the accumulator per AMM 12-15-11 resolves the problem temporarily, but if there is an active gas leak, the problem will re-occur at a later date.

Status

Closed

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Interim Action

N/A

Final Action

Boeing will continue reviewing 737MAX in-service events to determine if additional actions are required.

Operator Action

Boeing suggests that whenever the above symptoms are experienced, operators should thoroughly check for leaks on the gas side of the brake accumulator circuit using a soapy solution. One such soapy solution is a product called SNOOP made by Swagelok (www.swagelok.com). SNOOP is qualified to MIL-PRF-25567.

Operators should examine the following locations:

1) All tubing connections on the gas side of the accumulator circuit.

2) The charging valve. Be sure to remove the yellow cap to see if the valve is leaking through the center.

3) Check the aluminum charging manifold for leakage at the various ports.

4) Check the gage in the wheel well for leakage. There is some service history of gage leaks due to a rupture of the Bourdon tube internal to the gage. Sometimes the leak can be seen around the edges of the glass if the protective plastic cover is removed. However, a better place to check for a leak is on the back side of the gage since there is a vent hole on the gage housing (the vent hole is covered by a sticker). This may require an inspection mirror. See attached photos.

It is our experience that the brake accumulator itself is rarely at fault and so replacing the accumulator should be avoided until the troubleshooting efforts recommended above have been thoroughly performed. Replacing the accumulator unnecessarily causes excessive airplane down time, added maintenance cost, and most importantly does not permanently resolve the problem.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737NG-FTD-32-09010		

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- In Service Occurrences : null

Attachments:

a) Example of a Leaky Gage

b) Vent Hole on Gage

c) Example of a Leak at the Charging Valve

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